

Quaternium-15



What is it?

Quaternium-15 is a preservative. It is also a formaldehyde releaser. It is in many personal care and industrial products, as well as some topical medications.

Formaldehyde releasers are chemicals that may release formaldehyde. For this reason, if you are allergic to quaternium-15, you may also need to avoid formaldehyde and formaldehyde releasers.

QUATERNIUM-15 can also be known as:

- 1 - (3-Chloroallyl) - 3,5,7 - triaza - 1 - aminoadamantane chloride
- Chloroallyl methenamine chloride
- Azoniadamantane chloride
- Cis - 1 - (3-chloroallyl) 3,5,7 - triaza - 1 - azoniadamantane chloride
- Dowicil 75, 100, 200
- Methenamine - 3 - chloroallylchloride
- N - (3-Chloroallyl) hexaminium chloride
- Preventol D 1

Some Possible Uses of QUATERNIUM-15 / FORMALDEHYDE RELEASERS / Where it might be found:

- Make-up, make-up remover, toner
- Cleanser, cream, lotion, after shave
- Shampoo, conditioner, hair styling products
- Soap, body wash, bubble bath
- Mouthwash, root canal disinfectant
- Antiperspirant, hygiene spray
- Sunscreen, After-sun products
- Nail polish, cuticle remover, nail hardener
- Hand soap
- Laundry detergent, fabric softener
- Facial tissue, moist wipes, baby wipes

- Pet care items
- Paper (i.e. products, pulp, glazed)
- Newsprint, cardboard, magazines
- Grocery sacks, plastic bags
- Wet strength paper towels
- Money
- Photocopy toner, Photo developer
- Casts
- Foam insulator
- Bonded leather, fire resistant items
- Fertilizer
- Mildew resistant finish, preservative
- Embalming fluid, tissue fixative
- Waterproof glue, adhesive, rubber cement
- Latex emulsion, ink, etching material
- Paint (i.e. water based, primer, stripper)
- Wax, polish, wood cleaner, finish
- Plywood, masonite, particle board, MDF
- Asphalt shingles, flooring, filling agent
- Wood, coal, kerosene, charcoal smoke
- Smoke from cigars and cigarettes
- Natural gas combustion
- Tattoo ink

Other sources of QUATERNIUM-15 / FORMALDEHYDE RELEASER exposure:

Some topical medicated products may contain quaternium-15 and/or formaldehyde releasers.

Some examples include:

- Acne pads and cleansers
- Antifungals
- Anti-itch cream/gel/lotion
- Antiseptic spray
- Atopiclair
- Calcipotriene cream

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- Corticosteroids (clobetasol emollient cream, fluticasone cream and lotion, halobetasol cream)
- Crotamiton cream and lotion
- Ketoconazole shampoo
- Permethrin cream

Other products that may cross-react with QUATERNIUM-15:

You may need to avoid formaldehyde and its releasers, including:

- Imidazolidinyl urea
- Diazolidinyl urea
- Dimethyl dimethyl (DMDM) hydantoin
- Quaternium-15
- Bronopol (2-bromo-2-nitropropane-1,3-diol)
- Hexahydro-1,3,5-tris(2-hydroxyethyl)-s-triazine
- Tris nitromethane (i.e. Tris Nitrol)
- Sodium hydroxymethylglycinate
- Dimethyl imidazolidinone
- Dimethylol dihydroxyethyleneurea
- Melamine, Methenamine
- 1-(cis-3-Chloroallyl)-3,5,7-triaza-1-azoniaadamantane chloride
- Dowicil 75, Dowicil 100, Dowicil 200, Germall 116, Glydant, Grotan BK, Grotan B
- Triadine 10, Onyxdine 200, Onyxdine 500, Vancide TH, Myacide BT, Myacide AS

Quaternium compounds other than quaternium-15 (i.e. quaternium-18) do NOT release formaldehyde.

What should I do to avoid QUATERNIUM-15?

Check the ingredients of all items you use. Look for the names above. Products change often, so be sure to read all labels. For products already at home, go to the store and inspect the original package. Or look at the manufacturer's or store's website.

Tell your health care providers and others that take care of you about your allergy. Ask them to avoid items with formaldehyde. Tell your pharmacist as well.

To find a possible workplace exposure, check the ingredients list. Consult Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS) too. Or contact the manufacturer. Use of protection (i.e. clothing) or avoidance (i.e. a change in jobs) may be necessary.

If you are very sensitive, you may have difficulty with avoidance. Do not wear permanent press, wrinkle or crease resistant, or wash and wear fabric. Do not wear static, water, and mildew resistant, or flame-retardant fabric. Wash new clothing and bedding with one to two cups of powdered milk before use.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

REVISION DATE: DECEMBER 2025